

Be Curious

Judgment is the expensive part now. So where do you get any? Start with a fact worth sitting with. ChatGPT launched in late 2022. Every expert you'll ever compete with started learning these tools at almost the same moment you did. In most fields, adults have decades of experience on you. In AI, nobody has a ten-year head start, because the tools aren't ten years old.

That means the only seniority in AI is reps: hours spent actually using the tools, on real things, noticing what worked and what didn't. And reps are free. You don't need permission, a budget, or a job title. You need curiosity.

REPS BEAT TRICKS.

Prompt tricks expire every time the models update. Instincts don't. Knowing what the tool will be good at before you ask comes from one place: using it, often, on real things.

WHAT YOU'RE GOOD AT HAS A SHELF LIFE

Here's the part nobody says out loud, and it's why the reps never stop counting. Some of what you get good at is going to stop mattering, and not because you did anything wrong. A specific tool, a specific workflow, the exact trick that made you fast: all of it has a shelf life now, and the shelf life keeps getting shorter. Right now you have almost nothing to unlearn. That's a real advantage, and it's temporary. Give it a few years and you'll be the one holding a method that used to work.

So the skill isn't the method. It's what you do the week the method stops working. It looks like three habits: you try things before you know they'll work, you drop what you were good at when something better shows up, and you sit in not-knowing long enough to learn the new thing instead of retreating to the old one. That last one is the hard part. Being a beginner again, on purpose, is uncomfortable, and most people quit right there.

FIVE CURIOSITY HABITS

Staying a beginner on purpose sounds like a big move. In practice it's five small habits, and none of them take extra time out of your week. They're changes to things you already do.

1 Use it on real life, not just school

Planning a trip, fixing a bike, organizing a tournament, learning chords. Every new kind of task teaches you what the tool is actually good at. School assignments only show you a narrow slice.

2 Try the new thing the week it ships

New model, new feature: voice, vision, file uploads, whatever comes next. Most people wait until someone shows them. Be the one who already tried it.

3 Watch how other people use it

YouTube is full of people showing real AI workflows. Borrow what looks useful, then test it yourself before you trust it. You know how to check claims now. Use that.

4 Ask the tool to teach you the tool

The fastest way to find what you didn't know it could do is to ask.

"I want to get better at guitar. What are five different ways you could actually help me practice?"

5 Keep a list of what surprised you

Both directions. The time it nailed something hard, and the time it confidently botched something easy. The second list is the one that builds your when-not-to-trust-it instinct.

Most of this course will age. Models will change, the traps will mutate, and the prompt advice will go stale. The habit of being curious about the new thing is the one part that doesn't expire. Keep it.

Curiosity compounds.

The questions you chase become your edge.